K.L.E. Society's S. Nijalingappa College

2nd block, Rajajinagar, Bengaluru-10

Department of Computer Applications

Sponsored by

HACKMARCH 2.0 – STUDENT GUIDELINES & SCHEDULE

Organized by: KLE Society's S Nijalingappa College
Venue: KLE Society's S Nijalingappa College, Rajajinagar, Bengaluru - 560010
Sponsored by: Certisured, GoodAI and Builder Thinking
Hackathon Date: March 28, 2026

Welcome to HackMarch 2.0

This is not a typical hackathon.

This is about **understanding deeply, building early, and improving under pressure**.

IMPORTANT TIMELINE (BEFORE HACKATHON)

March 26 (Thursday)

- **Problem Statements Released**
- **Total: 3 Problems (1 per sponsor)**

✓ Certisured
✓ Builder Thinking
✓ GoodAI

All problem statements will be shared in the **official WhatsApp group**

March 26 – March 27 (24+ Hours Window)

You have **24+ hours** to:

- Read all problem statements carefully
- Think deeply
- Choose the one you feel **most intuitively connected to**

Do NOT rush this decision.

March 26 – 6:00 PM

- **Clarity Call**
- You can:
  - Ask doubts
  - Clarify expectations
  - Understand problem intent

March 27 – 9:00 PM (FINAL DEADLINE)

- You must:
  - **Select ONE problem statement**
  - Submit via **Google Form (shared in WhatsApp group)**

CRITICAL RULE

- Once submitted:
  - No changes allowed
  - No switching problems
  - No exceptions

Category Rule

- If **no team selects a problem**:
  - That category is **dropped**
  - That sponsor's **prize is removed**

Competition Reality

- If **everyone chooses the same problem**:
  - All teams compete for **ONE single prize**

This is intentional. Choose wisely.

TECHNOLOGY & TOOLS

- You are free to use:
  - Any programming language
  - Any framework
  - Any architecture
- You are allowed to use:
  - AI tools (paid or free)
  - Assistants (ChatGPT, Claude, etc.)
- Examples (not mandatory):
  - n8n
  - LangGraph
  - CrewAI

Important

Technology does NOT matter.
System thinking and execution DOES.

FACILITIES PROVIDED

- Tea & Snacks
- Lunch
- Water
- WiFi

EVALUATION STYLE (IMPORTANT)

NO PPTs

- Do NOT waste time on slides
- Negative impression if:
  - Time is spent on presentation instead of system

WHAT YOU MUST SHOW

Judges are looking for:

1. Do You Understand the Problem?

- Explain clearly in your own words
- Show depth, not memorization

2. Your System

- Demonstrate working solution
- Show:
  - UI
  - Backend
  - Flow

3. Your Thinking

- Why did you build it this way?
- What decisions did you take?

4. Your Tech Choices

- What tools/models did you use?
- Why those choices?

5. AI Usage Transparency

- Show:
  - Prompts used
  - Models used
  - Token usage (if applicable)

6. System Understanding

You must prove:
You know exactly how your system works

EVALUATION RUBRIC

Criteria	Weightage
Problem Understanding	**20%**
Working Solution (UI + Backend)	**40%**
System understanding & Explanation	**40%**

FAIRNESS POLICY

- Evaluation will be:
  - Strict
  - Unbiased
  - Merit-based

At all costs, **no bias will be allowed**
Only the **best solution will win**

FINAL NOTE

- All problems are:
  - Equal in difficulty
  - Equal in importance
- Sponsors are:
  - Investing to see **who can solve their problem best**

YOUR MINDSET

This is not about:

- Fancy UI
- Buzzwords
- Presentation

This is about:

Understanding → Building → Explaining

HACKATHON DAY – MARCH 28

Before Start

- **Registration must be completed by 9:00 AM**

EVENT FLOW

9:30 AM – 11:00 AM

Initial Evaluation Round

- Judges will visit each team
- You must:
  - Show what you have already built
  - Explain your understanding
- Judges may:
  - Ask questions
  - Suggest improvements

11:00 AM – 5:30 PM

Build & Improve Phase

- You continue developing your system
- Focus on:
  - Adding features
  - Improving clarity

    - Strengthening logic

This is where real work happens.

5:30 PM – HARD STOP

- All development must stop
- No further changes allowed

5:30 PM – 6:30 PM

Final Evaluation Round

- Judges will revisit **all teams**
- You must demonstrate:
    - What you improved
    - How your system works

6:30 PM – 7:00 PM

Valedictory and Prize Announcement

7:00 PM – 8:00 PM

Live Music Performance by

The VijayNarendraCollective

ALL THE BEST

Build something real.
Think deeply.
Show clarity.